

String Crossing: Three Techniques

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Technique #1: "hop" one finger between adjacent strings. Practice first with staccato eight notes, to emphasize the release upward to neutral before the string crossing. Make the hop at the last possible instant.

Staccato musical notation for Technique #1. The notation is in 4/4 time and consists of two staves. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The bottom staff is a bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The music is divided into four measures. The first measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (4th fret), each with a finger number 4 above it. The second measure contains four eighth notes on the A string (3rd fret), each with a finger number 3 above it. The third measure contains four eighth notes on the D string (2nd fret), each with a finger number 2 above it. The fourth measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (1st fret), each with a finger number 1 above it. The notation is marked with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Then, practice legato; the finger still releases up before crossing to the next string, but those two movements are very quick, leaving as little perceptible gap between notes as possible.

Legato musical notation for Technique #1. The notation is in 4/4 time and consists of two staves. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The bottom staff is a bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The music is divided into four measures. The first measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (4th fret), each with a finger number 4 above it. The second measure contains four eighth notes on the A string (3rd fret), each with a finger number 3 above it. The third measure contains four eighth notes on the D string (2nd fret), each with a finger number 2 above it. The fourth measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (1st fret), each with a finger number 1 above it. The notation is marked with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Technique #2: Use different fingers. Still practice first with short, separated notes.

Short notes musical notation for Technique #2. The notation is in 4/4 time and consists of two staves. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The bottom staff is a bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The music is divided into four measures. The first measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (4th fret), each with a finger number 4 above it. The second measure contains four eighth notes on the A string (3rd fret), each with a finger number 3 above it. The third measure contains four eighth notes on the D string (2nd fret), each with a finger number 2 above it. The fourth measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (1st fret), each with a finger number 1 above it. The notation is marked with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

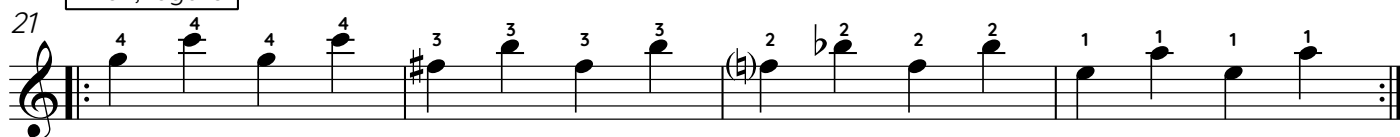
Then, as legato notes. Go for smoothness and consistency.

Legato musical notation for Technique #2. The notation is in 4/4 time and consists of two staves. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The bottom staff is a bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The music is divided into four measures. The first measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (4th fret), each with a finger number 4 above it. The second measure contains four eighth notes on the A string (3rd fret), each with a finger number 3 above it. The third measure contains four eighth notes on the D string (2nd fret), each with a finger number 2 above it. The fourth measure contains four eighth notes on the G string (1st fret), each with a finger number 1 above it. The notation is marked with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Technique #3: Collapse the tip joint to bar across two notes. Most of the time, we want the lower note to be muted when the upper note is played, so work on rolling the finger tip off the string, but just enough so that it stays in contact with and mutes the lower string. The upper note is played with the pad of the finger. You might find it useful to practice starting with finger 1. First, practice staccato:



Then, legato:



Since we will need to "think ahead" when using this technique and approaching from above, practice starting with the upper note. Prepare by playing the upper note with the pad of the finger and roll to the tip on the lower string.

